Their Back PAGES



Arunava Sinha
translates fiction, non-fiction and poetry from Bengali to English. His latest translation is ***Dear Reader: A Memoir****, by Sankar.*

Hardcore political allegory? A feminist fable? Magical realism? A love story? None/all of the above? K.R. Meera's *Qabar* (published by Eka), translated from the Malayalam by Nisha Susan, was impossible to pin down, which made reading it a magical as well as disturbing experience. What more can you ask for from a novel?

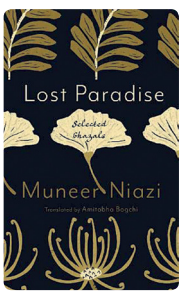
No matter what the theme of his fiction is, Jerry Pinto as novelist does life and Mumbai—not always in that order—in a way that plays with every sensation and feeling that you thought you had under control. *The Education of Yuri* (Speaking Tiger) was no exception.

Small things like these novels, one of them titled *Small Things Like These* (Grove Press), remind us that you don't need to write a doorstopper to tell a big, big story that will draw you in with its characters and sense of place or time. Claire Keegan's novel needs just over an hour to read, and stays with you for a long, long time.

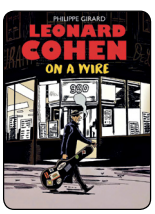
Amitabha Bagchi writes his fiction in English and candidly acknowledges being inspired by the greats of Hindustani writing. His novels carry the unmistakable strains of that music. Which is why his labour of love, the translations of Munir Niazi's ghazals into English, published as *Lost Paradise: Selected Ghazals* (Juggernaut), is such a pleasure to savour.

One of the joys of being fanatical about a musician is imagining the circumstances in which their best songs were written. When the musician in question is Leonard Cohen, it's necessary to imagine the backstory of every song of his. *Leonard Cohen: On a Wire* (Drawn & Quarterly), drawn and written by Philippe Girard in French and translated into English by Helge Dascher and Karen Houle, does just that in a wonderful graphic novel format. I read it as slowly as Cohen sang. ■





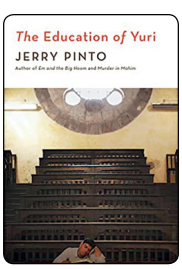
1. LOST PARADISE: SELECTED GHAZALS
by Munir Niazi; translated by Amitabha Bagchi



2. LEONARD COHEN: ON A WIRE
by Philippe Girard; translated by Helge Dascher and Karen Houle

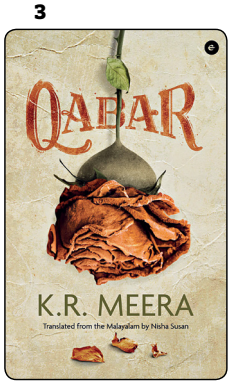


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3. QABAR
by K.R Meera; translated by Nisha Susan

4. SMALL THINGS LIKE THESE
by Claire Keegan

5. THE EDUCATION OF YURI
by Jerry Pinto